3.5.4 Attributes

An attribute is the information about that entity and it will describe, quantify, qualify, classify, and specify an entity. An attribute will always have a single value, that value can be a number or character or string.

Types of attributes:

1. Key Attribute
2. Simple Attributes
3. Composite Attributes
4. Single Valued Attribute
5. Multi Valued Attribute

3.5.4.1 Key Attribute

Generally a key attribute describes a unique characteristic of an entity.

3.5.4.2 Simple Attribute

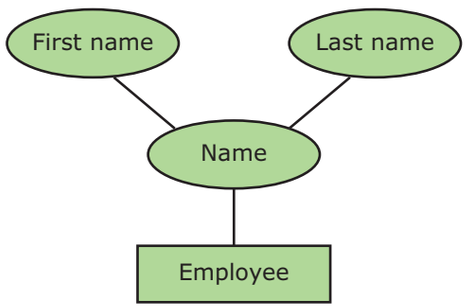


Figure 3.7 Simple Attribute

The simple attributes cannot be separated. It will have a single value for that entity. For Example: Let us consider the name as the attribute for the entity employee and here the value for that attribute is a single value. See Figure 3.7

3.5.4.3 Composite Attributes

The composite attributes can be sub-divided into simple attributes without change in the meaning of that attribute. For Example: In the above diagram the employee is the entity with the composite attribute Name which are sub-divided into two simple attributes first and last name.

3.5.4.4 Single Valued Attributes:

A single valued attribute contains only one value for the attribute and they don't have multiple number of values. For Example:Age- It is a single value for a person as we cannot give 'n' number of ages for a single person,therefore it is a single valued attribute. See Table 3.4

Table: 3.4 Single Valued Attributes

Attribute	Values
Age	3
Roll no	85

In the above table are the some examples for single valued attributes. See Figure 3.8

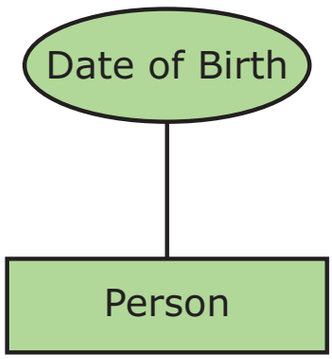


Figure 3.8 Single Valued Attributes

3.5.4.5 Multi Valued Attributes:

A multi valued attribute has more than one value for that particular attribute.For Example:Degree - A person can hold n number of degrees so it is a multi-valued attribute.

In Table 3.5 are some examples for Multi valued attributes.

Table: 3.5 Attributes and Values

Attribute	Values
Degree	B.Tech, MBA
Bank_Account	SBI, HDFC

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